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SUBMISSION GUIDANCE SUPPORT

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PUBLICATION SUPPORT SAMPLE

Submission Guidance Pack for Journal-Ready Filing

WHAT WE NEED	Manuscript, figures, target journal, and portal details.
WHAT YOU GET	Submission checklist, file review notes, portal preparation sheet, and cover letter pointers.
BEST SUITED FOR	Authors preparing an original research article or review for a Scopus / WoS indexed journal.

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1. Sample Submission Brief

Sample use case: A researcher wants support before submitting an original article to a journal in environmental materials science. The manuscript is scientifically promising but still carries common technical risks such as missing declarations, inconsistent file naming, and incomplete portal preparation.

Working manuscript title	Green synthesis of iron-modified biochar for phosphate removal from wastewater
Target journal	A mid-tier hybrid journal in environmental engineering / materials science
Article type	Original Research Article
Files received from client	Main manuscript, title page, 4 figures, 2 tables, graphical abstract draft, supplementary data sheet
Portal details available	Corresponding author details and abstract available; reviewer suggestions and declarations not yet organized
Main client concern	Avoid avoidable submission errors and make the package portal-ready in one round
Service output expected	Checklist, submission notes, file review, and cover letter support

2. Submission Readiness Checklist

This checklist is the main sample output. It shows what an author receives before entering the journal portal.

Checklist item	Status	Priority	Action / note
Main manuscript aligned to journal structure	Partial	High	Section order acceptable, but declarations section must be inserted before references.
Title page prepared separately	Ready	Medium	Author details and affiliations present; corresponding author marks should be checked.
Abstract within journal word limit	Ready	Low	Current abstract is 238 words and can fit most journals.
Keywords optimized and non-duplicative	Partial	Medium	Two keywords overlap strongly with title

Figures uploaded in accepted format	Partial	High	wording; refine for indexing value. Figure 2 and Figure 4 need higher resolution and consistent labeling style.
Graphical abstract / highlights requirement checked	Missing	High	Journal-specific requirement must be confirmed before final upload.
Conflict of interest statement present	Missing	High	Mandatory statement should be drafted even when there is no conflict.
Funding statement and acknowledgements checked	Partial	Medium	Funding source noted in manuscript, but grant number formatting should be standardized.
Suggested reviewer list prepared	Missing	Medium	Prepare 3-5 reviewers with institutional emails and non-conflicting affiliations.
File naming follows portal logic	Partial	Medium	Rename files clearly: Main_Manuscript, Title_Page, Figure_1, etc.

3. File-by-File Review Notes

This section demonstrates how we review each submission file, identify weak points, and guide the author on what should be uploaded separately.

File	Readiness	Observed issue	Guidance given
Main manuscript	Partial	Declarations missing; figure legends not fully consistent.	Insert ethics / conflict / data availability block and normalize legend style.
Title page	Ready	Minor formatting only.	Retain as separate file and verify author order against portal entry.
Figure 1	Ready	Clear image and caption match.	Upload as TIFF / high-quality PNG per journal instructions.
Figure 2	Partial	Axis labels are too small.	Increase font size and export at higher resolution before submission.
Figure 3	Ready	Scientifically clear; panel labels acceptable.	Keep labeling style consistent with Figure 4.
Figure 4	Partial	Color legend and panel title alignment uneven.	Re-export after visual clean-up to avoid reviewer confusion.
Graphical abstract draft	Missing	Requirement uncertain.	Confirm journal requirement; prepare only if mandatory or strategically helpful.
Supplementary file	Partial	Filename generic and citations inside text incomplete.	Rename as Supplementary_Data and cross-check all in-text references.

4. Portal Entry Preparation Sheet

Many strong manuscripts face delay because the portal fields are not prepared in advance. This sheet is a practical output researchers can use during submission.

Portal field	Status	Preparation note
Article title and running title	Ready	Keep wording identical across manuscript, title page, and portal.
Abstract	Ready	Paste cleaned version without hidden formatting from Word.

Keywords	Partial	Reduce duplication and align with indexing intent.
Author affiliations	Ready	Match superscripts, commas, and department names exactly.
Corresponding author details	Ready	Use active institutional email and full postal information if required.
Funding information	Partial	Standardize grant name and number formatting.
Conflict of interest statement	Missing	Prepare explicit declaration, even if none.
Author contributions	Missing	Draft CRediT-style roles if the journal requests them.
Suggested reviewers	Missing	Prepare names, affiliations, emails, and justification notes.
Data availability statement	Partial	Add repository link or justified availability note.

5. Cover Letter Pointers

A good cover letter should not repeat the abstract mechanically. It should help the editor understand novelty, fit, and manuscript integrity in one quick reading.

5.1 What the cover letter should include

- Clear manuscript title and article type.
- One concise statement of novelty: what is new, better, or more useful than existing studies.
- Why the manuscript fits the target journal readership and scope.
- A short statement confirming originality, exclusive submission, and author approval.
- Any ethics, funding, or conflict declarations that the journal expects at submission stage.

5.2 Common mistakes to avoid

- Copying the abstract into the cover letter without explaining journal fit.
- Using generic claims such as “our work is very important” without evidence.
- Forgetting to mention manuscript category or corresponding author details.
- Making novelty claims that are broader than the actual data supports.
- Leaving grammar, tone, and file naming inconsistent across documents.

5.3 Suggested cover letter structure

Opening	State the manuscript title, article type, and submission intent.
Novelty sentence	Explain the new contribution in one strong, evidence-based sentence.
Journal fit	Show why the work matters to the journal’s audience or scope.
Integrity note	Confirm originality, author approval, and absence / presence of conflict.
Closing	Thank the editor and provide corresponding author contact details.

6. Submission Risk Alerts

- Mismatch between author order on the title page and the portal entry can delay editorial processing.
- Low-resolution figures create a poor first impression and may trigger technical queries before review.
- Missing conflict, data availability, or funding statements are among the most common avoidable omissions.
- Unclear file names increase the chance of uploading the wrong version to the wrong portal field.
- A weak cover letter reduces editorial confidence, especially when the journal fit is not obvious from the title alone.

7. Final Recommendation Summary

Overall readiness level: Moderately ready, but not yet safe for direct portal submission.

Immediate actions	Insert declarations, finalize figure quality, and prepare reviewer suggestions.
Strong points	Title page is clean, abstract is manageable, and the manuscript has a journal-suitable structure.
Main technical risks	Missing mandatory statements, uncertain auxiliary file requirements, and incomplete portal preparation.
Recommended next step	Complete the checklist, finalize all files with clear naming, and submit only after a last cross-check against the target journal instructions.

8. What this sample demonstrates

- We do not only read a paper; we prepare the full submission logic around it.
- We identify missing items before the journal portal does.
- We help authors move from “almost ready” to “submission ready” with practical, editable guidance.

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THANK YOU

SUBMISSION GUIDANCE SUPPORT TOOLKIT SAMPLE

Submit with better clarity, preparation, and journal-ready confidence.

We help researchers improve
submission checklist readiness • journal guideline
compliance • cover letter planning • file preparation •
metadata accuracy • final submission confidence

Need help before submission?

Send your manuscript draft, target journal, author
guidelines, or submission stage and get a
Free sample submission guidance review.

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